

Wani Powers: When they assume their wani form, chu jung embrace the flame that surrounds them, automatically soaking their Stamina in levels of damage from fire. In addition, damage taken from flame is lethal, not aggravated.

Hou-Chi

The spirits of wood are calm and contemplative, dwelling in their groves and forests, their gardens and farms. They know each tree, each bush, each blade of grass, and care for each in turn. Woe betide those who threaten what a hou-chi protects, be they shen or mortal, for the wrath of nature is fierce indeed, and a hou-chi's friends are many — the very forest turns against intruders, vines strangling the wicked and branches lashing at the unwelcome.

Appearance: In hotei form, hou-chi often have irises of rich green — in elders, these eyes may even turn brown according to the season. In their wani form, hou-chi are tall, graceful, long of limb, and have verdant emerald or rough brown skin. When they employ the Mask of Shintai, their height seems to redouble, their arms and legs becoming terrifyingly long, their voice booming with their fury.

Lifestyle: Because they feel so uncomfortable in cities and highly-developed areas, it follows that most hou-chi avoid such places, preferring a life surrounded by nature. While some do dwell in city parks or greenbelts, natural settings are superior to the imitations of mortals. hou-chi are often active in environmental causes, opposing development plans that would threaten the natural world regardless of whether they might actually help the mortal population.

Fortune: Wood

Luck: A hou-chi is attuned to the cycle of life and death, and as such may ease the suffering of all beings that cycle touches. By spending a point of Yugen, she may soothe the pain of any living being in her immediate presence, allowing them to ignore wound penalties equal to her Yin Chi for a scene.

Curse: Tied intimately to the natural world, the absence of living things weakens the hou-chi. If she cannot rest in healthy soil each night, all physical actions are made at +1 difficulty until she can do so.

Wani Powers: As the elemental essence of wood flows through the hou-chi, she suffers less from its touch. She automatically soaks her Stamina in health levels of damage from

any wooden weapon or object, including arrows (even if they are tipped with stone or steel). No natural venoms or poisons may harm her.

Komuko

Enamored of tradition and stability, komuko are revered even above the other kamuii for their air of serenity and their connection to the 10,000 Things. However, their deeply-rooted and solid nature can make them difficult to relate to — oth-

